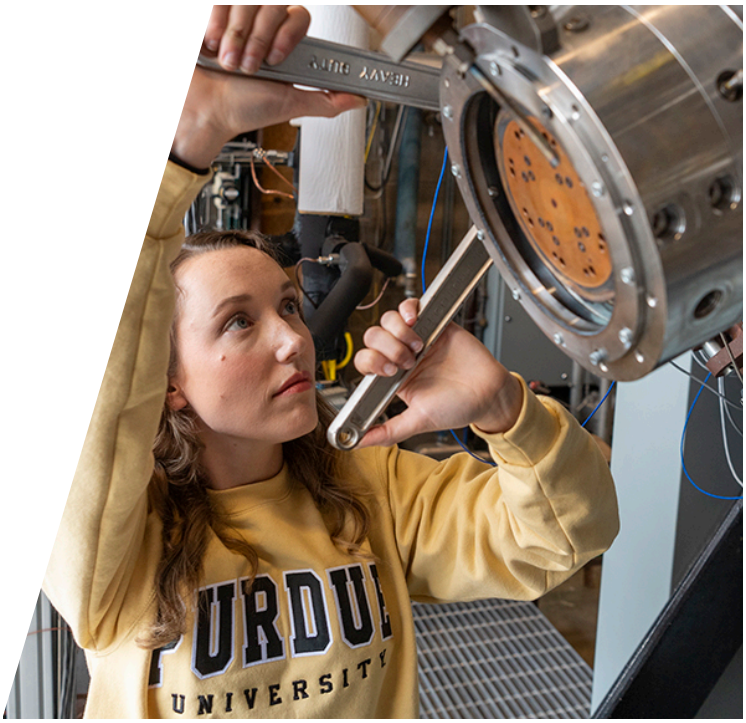
Aeronautical and Astronautical Engineering

Tackle real-world challenges in the design and development of aircraft, spacecraft and space systems. From the skies to deep space, this is where bold engineers are built.



JUMP TO: CAREERS CONNECT TRANSFER

Program Summary

As an aeronautical and astronautical engineer, apply your understanding of basic physical phenomena to the design, development, analysis, testing and production of aircraft, missiles and space vehicles. Aeronautics focuses on aircraft for military or civilian markets, while astronautics specializes in rockets, spacecraft and global space and international systems.

From the fundamentals of engineering science to full system design, gain hands-on experience bringing big ideas to life in the largest academic propulsion lab in the world. Design courses in aircraft and spacecraft integrate many engineering fields to provide a mastery of complete flight systems, preparing you for a career in aerospace engineering, space exploration and beyond.

EXPLORE PLAN OF STUDY

Quick Facts

- **Degree:** Bachelor of Science
- **Location(s):** West Lafayette
- **College/School:** Engineering

REQUEST INFORMATION

WHY PURDUE?

WATCH VIDEO

#3

UNDERGRADUATE PROGRAM IN THE U.S.

U.S. News & World Report, 2025

$82,272

AVERAGE STARTING SALARY

Purdue Center for Career Opportunities, 2025

APPLYING

Applying to Engineering in West Lafayette

To study aeronautical and astronautical engineering at Purdue, you will apply to the first-year engineering program. All engineering students in West Lafayette build a foundation for success by completing core first-year engineering curriculum

before transitioning to a specialty major in the second year. Core curriculum includes courses in math, chemistry, physics, computer programming and communication skills, as well as introductory engineering coursework that explores career options to help you identify which specialty major is the right fit.

The priority application deadline for first-year engineering is Nov. 1. Applications received after Nov. 1 for this competitive major will be evaluated based on available space.

Possible Careers

With a degree in aeronautical and astronautical engineering, our students thrive in aviation, defense, space exploration — even automotive industries with careers such as:

- Aerospace engineer
- Defense contractor engineer
- Intelligence or surveillance systems engineer
- Mission operations engineer
- Orbital analyst
- Propulsion engineer
- Quality assurance/test engineer

Internships and Graduate Hires

High School Course Recommendations

CONNECT

College of Engineering

Explore nearly 20 majors in one of the best engineering schools in the country for academics and career preparation.

LEARN MORE

Contact

Office of Future Engineers
(765) 494-3975
future-engineers@purdue.edu

EMAIL

Visit

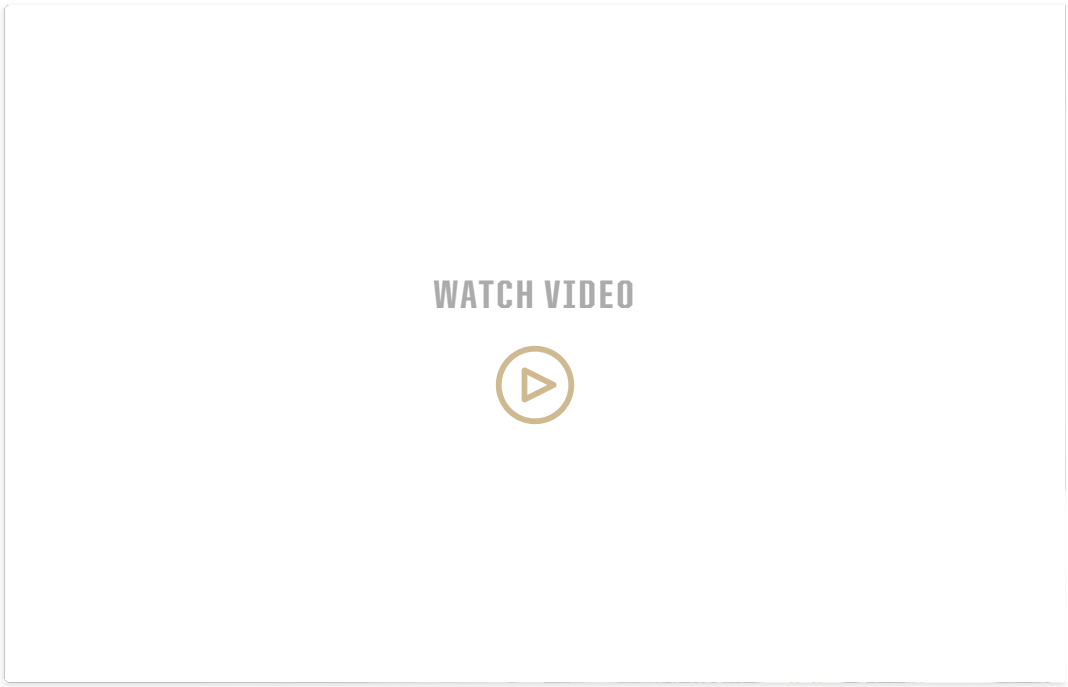
Experience for yourself all that Purdue has to offer with opportunities to explore in-person or virtually.

SCHEDULE A VISIT

Apply

Ready to take the next step? Apply to begin your journey at Purdue in engineering.

APPLY NOW



Meet Our Students

Abigail

For Abigail Mizzi, Purd
Engineering felt like h
After visiting through t
Engineering program,
support — and even m
enrolled. From study g
to faculty mentors, Ab
“Every community I’ve
Purdue has just been

Transfer to Aeronautical and Astronautical Engineering



Purdue admits to individual majors. Transfer students must meet Purdue's overall transfer criteria, as well as any major-specific requirements. Before you apply, check the closed programs page to confirm this major is open to transfer students. If it is, refer to the information below for major-specific transfer criteria.

- Minimum 3.0 GPA
- For detailed admissions requirements to transfer into any of Purdue's engineering majors, review our engineering transfer criteria.

LEARN MORE

RELATED MAJORS

VIEW ALL MAJORS

Agricultural Engineering

College of Engineering

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Biological Engineering

Tackle global challenges in health, food, energy and the environment....

LEARN MORE

Biomedical Engineering

Join a dynamic field at the crossroads of engineering, medicine and scienc...

LEARN MORE

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